Exam Tips — CLF-C02

Before the exam

- Book via **AWS Certification (aws.training/certification)** → Pearson VUE (test center or online proctored).
- Online proctoring: quiet room, clean desk, valid ID, webcam, stable internet, system test beforehand.
- If English is not your first language, you may be eligible for the **ESL +30 minutes accommodation** — request it **before** booking/scheduling (check current AWS policy).
- Sleep well. Don't cram new services the night before — review 06 glossary.

During the exam

- **Never leave a question blank** — no penalty for guessing.
- ~80 seconds per question. **Flag** long ones and return.
- **Read the last sentence first** (what is being asked), then the scenario.
- Eliminate two obviously wrong answers, then choose.
- Multiple-response: the question tells you how many to select — pick exactly that many.
- Watch keywords: **most cost-effective**, **least operational overhead**, **highly available**, **fully managed**, **serverless**, **minimum effort**, **fastest**, **secure**.
- AWS answers are usually the **managed/serverless** option; "do it yourself on EC2" is usually a distractor (unless control is required).
- Questions are conceptual — **don't overthink**; pick the service that matches the stated use case.

Keyword to service

See the "which service?" table in the Domain 3 document: it covers the same keyword-to-service mapping.

Traps to watch

1. **Elasticity vs scalability** (elasticity = automatic, both directions).
2. **Shared responsibility**: guest OS on EC2 = customer; RDS engine patching = AWS; data & IAM = always customer.
3. **SG = stateful, allow-only, instance**; **NACL = stateless, allow+deny, subnet**.
4. **CloudTrail (who) vs CloudWatch (performance) vs Config (configuration)**.
5. **Shield Standard = free & automatic**; Advanced = paid. **WAF = layer 7**.
6. **Data IN is free; data OUT is charged.**
7. **Region ≠ AZ ≠ edge location.** CloudFront uses edge locations.
8. **Root user**: MFA, no access keys, only for root-only tasks.
9. **Spot** can be interrupted.
10. **Savings Plans (flexible) vs Reserved Instances (specific).**
11. **Support plans (v1.3)**: Basic = no technical cases; **Business Support+** = 24/7, minimum for production; **Enterprise Support** = designated TAM; **Unified Operations** = mission-critical, < 5 min. Legacy names (Developer, Business, On-Ramp) may still appear.
12. **S3 One Zone-IA = single AZ** (data lost if the AZ is lost).
13. **Instance store is ephemeral**; **EBS is persistent**.
14. **Cost allocation tags must be activated.**

Last-day checklist

- ☐ 6 Well-Architected pillars · 6 CAF perspectives · 7 Rs · 6 advantages of cloud
- ☐ Shared responsibility table (EC2 / RDS / Lambda / S3)
- ☐ IAM: user/group/role/policy, root tasks, MFA
- ☐ Security services map (GuardDuty/Inspector/Macie/Detective/Security Hub/Shield/WAF)
- ☐ CloudTrail vs CloudWatch vs Config
- ☐ Compute/storage/database/network "which service" table
- ☐ S3 classes (order hot → cold)
- ☐ Pricing options + data transfer rules + cost tools + support plans

05 · Practice Questions (original, scenario-style)

> These 70 questions are **written by me for learning**, in the style of the exam (concepts + scenarios). They are **not** real exam questions or dumps. Answers and explanations are at the end of each domain section. Cover the answers, commit to one before checking. Target: **≥ 80%** on a first pass, **≥ 90%** on the second pass after reviewing mistakes.

Questions marked **(choose 2)** are multiple response.

Domain 1 — Cloud Concepts (15)

Q1. A startup wants to avoid buying servers up front and only pay for what it uses. Which cloud advantage is this? A. Massive economies of scale B. Trade fixed expense for variable expense C. Go global in minutes D. Increase speed and agility

Q2. A shop's traffic spikes on Black Friday and drops afterwards. Resources must automatically grow and shrink. Which concept? A. Fault tolerance B. Durability C. Elasticity D. Compliance

Q3. Which Well-Architected pillar covers *automatically recovering from failure* and *scaling horizontally*? A. Security B. Reliability C. Performance Efficiency D. Sustainability

Q4. A company wants to run workloads with the *smallest possible carbon footprint* by maximizing utilization. Which pillar? A. Cost Optimization B. Operational Excellence C. Sustainability D. Reliability

Q5. Which are perspectives of the AWS Cloud Adoption Framework? **(choose 2)** A. Platform B. Networking C. Governance D. Compute E. Billing

Q6. A company moves its virtual machines to Amazon EC2 with **no changes** as quickly as possible. Which migration strategy? A. Refactor B. Repurchase C. Rehost D. Retire

Q7. A company moves a self-managed MySQL database on a VM to Amazon RDS with minimal changes. Which strategy? A. Replatform B. Relocate C. Retain D. Rehost

Q8. Which service helps migrate a database with minimal downtime? A. AWS SCT B. AWS DMS C. AWS DataSync D. AWS Snowball

Q9. *(`LEGACY` legacy topic — Snow Family is not on the v1.3 list)* A customer needs to transfer 80 TB of data to AWS and has slow internet. Which is the best fit? A. AWS VPN B. Amazon Route 53 C. AWS Snow Family D. AWS Transit Gateway

Q10. Which statement about CapEx and OpEx is correct? A. Cloud moves spending from OpEx to CapEx B. Cloud moves spending from CapEx to OpEx C. Cloud eliminates all costs D. Cloud requires upfront hardware purchase

Q11. What is *rightsizing*? A. Buying the largest instance B. Matching resource size to actual workload needs C. Moving to another Region D. Reserving capacity for 3 years

Q12. Which AWS service enables repeatable provisioning of infrastructure from templates? A. AWS CloudTrail B. AWS CloudFormation C. AWS Config D. AWS Trusted Advisor

Q13. Which are examples of *managed services* that reduce operational overhead? **(choose 2)** A. Amazon RDS B. MySQL installed on EC2 C. Amazon DynamoDB D. Self-managed Kubernetes on EC2 E. A physical rack

Q14. A company can reuse existing per-socket software licenses on AWS. What is this model called? A. License included B. Bring Your Own License (BYOL) C. Spot licensing D. On-demand licensing

Q15. Which design principle belongs to *Operational Excellence*? A. Perform operations as code B. Encrypt data at rest C. Use Spot Instances D. Use edge locations

Answers — Domain 1

1. **B** — variable expense replaces upfront investment.
2. **C** — elasticity = automatic scale out *and* in.
3. **B** — Reliability.
4. **C** — Sustainability (maximize utilization, efficient hardware).
5. **A, C** — Platform and Governance (also Business, People, Security, Operations).
6. **C** — Rehost = lift and shift.
7. **A** — Replatform.
8. **B** — DMS migrates DBs; SCT only converts schema.
9. **C** — Snow Family for large offline transfers.
0. **B** — CapEx → OpEx.
1. **B**.
2. **B** — CloudFormation (IaC).

3. **A, C**.
4. **B**.
5. **A** — operations as code.

Domain 2 — Security and Compliance (18)

Q16. Who is responsible for patching the guest OS of an Amazon EC2 instance? A. AWS B. The customer C. Both equally D. The hypervisor vendor

Q17. Under the shared responsibility model, AWS is responsible for which of the following? **(choose 2)** A. Physical security of data centers B. Customer data classification C. Hypervisor and host infrastructure D. IAM policies E. Security group rules

Q18. A customer wants to download AWS compliance reports such as SOC and ISO. Which service? A. AWS Config B. AWS Artifact C. AWS Audit Manager D. AWS Inspector

Q19. Which service records *who* made API calls in an account and *when*? A. Amazon CloudWatch B. AWS CloudTrail C. AWS Config D. Amazon Inspector

Q20. Which service evaluates whether resource configurations comply with rules and keeps configuration history? A. AWS Config B. AWS CloudTrail C. Amazon GuardDuty D. AWS Artifact

Q21. Which service uses ML to detect compromised instances or unusual API activity by analyzing CloudTrail, VPC Flow Logs and DNS logs? A. Amazon Inspector B. Amazon Macie C. Amazon GuardDuty D. AWS WAF

Q22. Which service discovers sensitive data such as PII stored in Amazon S3? A. Amazon Macie B. Amazon GuardDuty C. AWS Shield D. AWS KMS

Q23. A company wants to protect against SQL injection and cross-site scripting attacks on its web application behind an ALB. Which service? A. AWS Shield Standard B. AWS WAF C. Amazon Inspector D. Security group

Q24. Which service provides automatic, free DDoS protection to all AWS customers? A. AWS Shield Advanced B. AWS Shield Standard C. AWS WAF D. AWS Firewall Manager

Q25. A security team wants a single dashboard aggregating findings from GuardDuty, Inspector and Macie across accounts. Which service? A. AWS Security Hub B. AWS Trusted Advisor C. AWS Config D. Amazon Detective

Q26. What best describes an IAM role? A. A user with permanent credentials B. An identity with temporary credentials assumed by a trusted entity C. A group of users D. A billing account

Q27. What is the best practice for the AWS account root user? A. Create access keys and share with admins B. Use it daily for administration C. Enable MFA and avoid using it for everyday tasks D. Delete it

Q28. Which of these tasks can **only** be done by the root user? **(choose 2)** A. Launch an EC2 instance B. Close the AWS account C. Create an IAM user D. Change the AWS Support plan E. Create an S3 bucket

Q29. What is the main difference between security groups and network ACLs? A. SGs are stateless, NACLs stateful B. SGs are stateful at instance level; NACLs are stateless at subnet level C. Both work at the subnet level D. NACLs are allow-only

Q30. An IAM policy has an explicit Deny and an explicit Allow for the same action. What happens? A. Allowed B. Denied C. Depends on policy order D. AWS asks the admin

Q31. Which service lets workforce users sign in once and access multiple AWS accounts? A. Amazon Cognito B. AWS IAM Identity Center C. AWS KMS D. AWS Directory Service only

Q32. Which service creates and manages encryption keys and integrates with S3, EBS and RDS? A. AWS KMS B. AWS CloudHSM only C. AWS Shield D. AWS Artifact

Q33. Which service gives you a *dedicated hardware security module* under your control? A. AWS KMS B. AWS CloudHSM C. ACM D. Secrets Manager

Answers — Domain 2

6. **B** — customer (guest OS).
7. **A, C**.
8. **B** — Artifact.
9. **B** — CloudTrail.
10. **A** — Config.
11. **C** — GuardDuty.
12. **A** — Macie.
13. **B** — WAF (Layer 7).
14. **B** — Shield Standard.
15. **A** — Security Hub.

26. **B**.
27. **C**.
28. **B, D**.
29. **B**.
30. **B** — explicit deny always wins.
31. **B** — IAM Identity Center.
32. **A** — KMS.
33. **B** — CloudHSM.

Domain 3 — Cloud Technology and Services (20)

Q34. Which describes an Availability Zone? A. A geographic area with many Regions B. One or more discrete data centers in a Region with redundant power and networking C. A CloudFront cache site D. A VPN endpoint

Q35. Why deploy across multiple Availability Zones? A. Lower price B. High availability C. Data sovereignty D. Higher bandwidth

Q36. A company needs consistent, dedicated, private network performance between its data center and AWS. Which service? A. AWS Site-to-Site VPN B. AWS Direct Connect C. Internet Gateway D. Route 53

Q37. Which instance family is best for a memory-intensive in-memory database? A. Compute optimized B. Memory optimized C. Storage optimized D. General purpose

Q38. Which service runs code in response to events without provisioning servers, and bills per request and duration? A. Amazon EC2 B. AWS Lambda C. Amazon Lightsail D. AWS Outposts

Q39. Which service runs containers without managing servers or clusters of EC2? A. AWS Fargate B. Amazon ECR C. Amazon EC2 D. AWS Batch

Q40. Which service distributes incoming traffic across multiple EC2 instances in several AZs? A. Auto Scaling B. Elastic Load Balancing C. Route 53 only D. CloudFront

Q41. A developer uploads code and wants AWS to handle provisioning, load balancing and scaling. Which service? A. AWS Elastic Beanstalk B. AWS CloudFormation C. Amazon EC2 D. AWS Lambda

Q42. Which AWS database is serverless NoSQL with single-digit millisecond latency? A. Amazon RDS B. Amazon DynamoDB C. Amazon Redshift D. Amazon Neptune

Q43. Which service is a data warehouse for large-scale analytics? A. Amazon Redshift B. Amazon Aurora C. Amazon ElastiCache D. Amazon DocumentDB

Q44. Which service converts the database schema when migrating from Oracle to PostgreSQL? A. AWS DMS B. AWS SCT C. AWS Snowball D. AWS Backup

Q45. A resource in a private subnet needs outbound internet access for updates but must not be reachable from the internet. What should be used? A. Internet Gateway attached to the instance B. NAT Gateway C. VPC peering D. Direct Connect

Q46. Which service caches content at edge locations to reduce latency for global users? A. Amazon CloudFront B. AWS Direct Connect C. Amazon VPC D. AWS Outposts

Q47. Which S3 storage class automatically moves objects between access tiers based on changing access patterns? A. S3 Standard-IA B. S3 One Zone-IA C. S3 Intelligent-Tiering D. S3 Glacier Deep Archive

Q48. A company must archive data for 10 years at the lowest possible cost; retrieval can take hours. Which class? A. S3 Standard B. S3 Glacier Deep Archive C. S3 One Zone-IA D. S3 Intelligent-Tiering

Q49. Which storage is *ephemeral* and lost when the EC2 instance is stopped or terminated? A. EBS volume B. EC2 instance store C. S3 D. EFS

Q50. Multiple Linux EC2 instances need a shared file system. Which service? A. Amazon EBS B. Amazon EFS C. Amazon S3 Glacier D. Instance store

Q51. Which service performs SQL queries directly on data stored in Amazon S3 without servers? A. Amazon Athena B. Amazon Redshift C. AWS Glue D. Amazon EMR

Q52. Which service builds conversational chatbots? A. Amazon Polly B. Amazon Lex C. Amazon Transcribe D. Amazon Comprehend

Q53. Which service decouples application components using a message queue? A. Amazon SNS B. Amazon SQS C. Amazon EventBridge D. AWS Step Functions

Answers — Domain 3

54. **B**.
55. **B**.

36. **B** — Direct Connect.
37. **B** — Memory optimized.
38. **B** — Lambda.
39. **A** — Fargate.
40. **B** — ELB.
41. **A** — Elastic Beanstalk.
42. **B** — DynamoDB.
43. **A** — Redshift.
44. **B** — SCT.
45. **B** — NAT Gateway.
46. **A** — CloudFront.
47. **C** — Intelligent-Tiering.
48. **B** — Glacier Deep Archive.
49. **B** — Instance store.
50. **B** — EFS.
51. **A** — Athena.
52. **B** — Lex.
53. **B** — SQS.

Domain 4 — Billing, Pricing, and Support (7 + bonus)

Q54. Which pricing option offers up to ~90% discount but can be interrupted by AWS with a 2-minute notice? A. On-Demand B. Spot Instances C. Reserved Instances D. Dedicated Hosts

Q55. A company runs a steady workload for 3 years and wants the biggest discount with some flexibility across instance families. Which option? A. Compute Savings Plans B. On-Demand C. Spot D. Capacity Reservations

Q56. Which tool estimates the cost of an architecture *before* you deploy it? A. AWS Budgets B. AWS Pricing Calculator C. AWS Cost Explorer D. AWS CUR

Q57. Which tool sends alerts when actual or forecasted costs exceed a threshold? A. AWS Budgets B. AWS Cost Explorer C. AWS Trusted Advisor D. AWS Config

Q58. A finance analyst needs the most detailed line-item cost and usage data in S3. Which service? A. AWS Cost and Usage Report B. AWS Budgets C. AWS Pricing Calculator D. AWS Billing Conductor

Q59. Which support plan is the lowest tier that provides 24/7 phone, email and chat access to Cloud Support Engineers? A. Basic Support B. Business Support+ C. Enterprise Support D. Unified Operations

Q60. Which of the following is true about AWS Organizations consolidated billing? A. It costs extra B. It combines usage across accounts for volume discounts and can share Reserved Instance discounts C. It prevents using IAM D. It only works with one account

Answers — Domain 4

54. **B**.
55. **A** — Compute Savings Plans.
56. **B**.
57. **A**.
58. **A**.
59. **B** — Business Support+ (legacy name: *Business*). Basic has no technical cases.
60. **B**.

Added for guide v1.3 (new names and new in-scope items) (10)

Q61. A company wants EC2 instances to reach an AWS service privately, without traffic crossing the public internet. Which service? A. AWS PrivateLink B. Amazon CloudFront C. AWS Shield D. Amazon Route 53

Q62. A company must connect dozens of VPCs and its on-premises network through a single central hub. Which service? A. VPC peering for each pair B. AWS Transit Gateway C. Internet Gateway D. Amazon Route 53

Q63. Which service lets a customer view and request increases for AWS service quotas (limits)? A. AWS Service Quotas B. AWS Budgets C. AWS Config D. AWS Artifact

Q64. Which service helps build a business case and TCO for migrating on-premises servers to AWS? A. AWS Migration Evaluator B. AWS Backup C. AWS CloudTrail D. Amazon Inspector

Q65. Which AWS service provides a generative-AI-powered assistant for business and development tasks? A. Amazon Q B. Amazon Polly C. Amazon Textract D. AWS Glue

Q66. Amazon Quick (formerly Amazon QuickSight) is primarily used for… A. Business intelligence dashboards and visualizations B. Streaming data ingestion C. Container orchestration D. DDoS protection

Q67. Which support plan includes a **designated TAM** and a **< 15-minute** response for business-critical system down? A. Basic Support B. Business Support+ C. AWS Enterprise Support D. Developer Support

Q68. A company runs mission-critical workloads and wants a **< 5-minute** response for critical incidents plus continuous resiliency reviews. Which option? A. Business Support+ B. AWS Unified Operations C. Basic Support D. Trusted Advisor

Q69. A team wants a managed, MongoDB-compatible document database. Which service? A. Amazon DocumentDB B. Amazon RDS for MySQL C. Amazon Redshift D. Amazon ElastiCache

Q70. Employees need secure **browser** access to internal web apps and SaaS without a full virtual desktop. Which service? A. Amazon WorkSpaces Secure Browser B. Amazon AppStream 2.0 only C. AWS Direct Connect D. Amazon Connect

Answers — v1.3 additions

61. **A** — PrivateLink (private connectivity to services).
62. **B** — Transit Gateway.
63. **A** — Service Quotas.
64. **A** — Migration Evaluator.
65. **A** — Amazon Q.
66. **A** — BI dashboards.
67. **C** — Enterprise Support (designated TAM, < 15 min).
68. **B** — Unified Operations (< 5 min, continuous resiliency reviews).
69. **A** — DocumentDB.
70. **A** — WorkSpaces Secure Browser (formerly WorkSpaces Web).

Score yourself

Score	Next step
< 60%	Re-read the domain files, then redo
60–79%	Review weak domains, make flashcards of mistakes
80–89%	Good. Do a timed mock from official AWS practice resources
≥ 90%	Ready — book the exam

> For realistic timed practice, use **official AWS resources (AWS Skill Builder: Cloud Practitioner Official Practice Question Set / Exam Prep)** — never exam dumps.